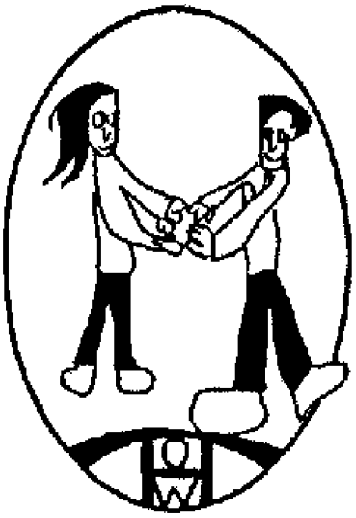
Howbridge Infant School



Art Policy

Date last reviewed by Governing Body: March 2026

Howbridge Infant School

POLICY NAME Art Policy
DATE OF REVIEW Spring 2026

Aims and priorities for subject teaching and learning
Art is taught as part of a broad and balanced curriculum. Our intent is for all children to enjoy the elements of art regardless of gender or ethnic group, and to develop skills and positive attitudes that allow them to have success in a variety of projects. Our aim is for children to think creatively, and be engaged, inspired and challenged and be able to use a range of media (for example drawing, painting, sculpture). Children should combine practical skills with other needs such as function and aesthetics, and evaluate their work in a critical manner. Children should be able to explore and experiment with a variety of materials and tools, confidently applying them to their work. We would encourage children to be aware of how art reflects and shapes our history, and contributes to our diverse culture.
Sources used for the scheme of work
In the Early Years Foundation Stage teaching activities and learning objectives are taken from the EYFS Statutory Framework. For Years 1 and 2 the basis for learning objectives and activities are contained within The Primary National Curriculum framework. The art curriculum map has been developed using skills to ensure progression. Cross curricular links to other subjects are made to create a more holistic approach to the curriculum.
Visitors
Links with other schools and organisations will support the development of skills for teachers, teaching assistants and children. We are also linked with the Braintree District Cultural Education Partnership.
Strategies for teaching
Teaching strategies vary according to the needs of the class and the themes being taught. In KS1, art is taught weekly or fortnightly, class teachers follow the curriculum map and teach a variety of skill based lessons through a termly theme. All classes also do a range of cross curricular creative work throughout the year. In the Foundation Stage activities are part of each week's learning programme. Skills will also be taught through Art lessons delivered by teachers following plans created by teachers with a passion for art to impact the quality of lessons being delivered. There are a number of lunchtime clubs relating to Art such as Christmas craft and drawing club, which are held during the year and support the development of skills. Each year group also experiences a creative day every year, which involves a performance at the end.
Planning, marking and feedback
There are long, short and medium term plans which outline the objectives for the year. Every term KS1 follows the same topic, for example autumn term has 'Portraiture' as a focus. This shows a clear progression of skills. For example, in year 1 sketching observational drawings and in year 2 using sketching techniques such as shading within their observational drawings. Each child in KS1 has a sketchbook and this shows the skills that are being taught. In the library area we have an Art Gallery, which showcases examples of the Year 1 and 2 art and demonstrates the progression through year groups. This is a working wall so each term work can be added. In EYFS, each child has their own folder where adult lead and continuous provision is stored and other individual examples may be photographed and stored online on Tapestry. Feedback is often in the moment and interactive; pupils are encouraged to evaluate theirs and others' work at all stages from design to completion.

Assessment, recording and reporting

Assessments are made regularly, recorded and reported to parents following school and National guidelines.

Teachers' planning, assessment notes and the pupils' work/completed tasks form the evidence base. Photographic evidence is kept of some activities (outdoor art work). A formal assessment is made each term by class teachers on Sonar. These are reviewed by subject leaders and are used to plan future actions within the Art action plan. Teacher assessments are reported to parents in pupils' annual reports. Parents can look at pupils' work at school events such as open mornings/afternoons and consultation sessions and during special assemblies.

Inclusion - equal opportunities, racial awareness, gender, higher potential, SEN

We aim to set suitable learning targets, respond to pupils' diverse needs and overcome potential barriers to learning and assessment for groups and individuals.

All children have equal access to activities, which are adapted if necessary for children with special needs. Special talents or abilities are noted on individual pupil profiles and teachers adapt and extend tasks specifically for those children. Children are exposed to a wide range of artists from ethnically and culturally diverse backgrounds to inspire them and develop children's cultural awareness.

Teachers will always be flexible when teaching Art in order to support children's well-being, mental health, behaviour and sensory needs, making teaching and learning therapeutic e.g. taking learning outside, allowing learners to work on the floor.

Resource use, monitoring and acquisition

Resources are reviewed annually and matched to units of work. Year team leaders identify other resource needs from planning and advise the subject coordinator. We try and order sustainable resources in line with our Climate Action Policy. Children are taught to only take what they need and be conscious of unnecessary waste and use the correct recycling bin. Each class is equipped with a good range of Art equipment, which children can easily access. Some resources which are less frequently used or difficult to store are to be found centrally within the school. Books related to the Art and specific artists can be found in the school library and art cupboard.

Links with other subjects

Art makes cross curricular links with Computing and with the health and safety aspects of PSHE. Skills learned in other subjects, particularly English and Maths are applied in units of work. All teachers and children have the use of iPads within school which can be used to aid learning. Elements of PSHE can be incorporated into the schemes of work including collaborative working and health and safety. Speaking and listening objectives can be applied to the children's work, as discussion often forms an integral part of the making and applying process. Children are also encouraged to listen carefully to others' suggestions and ideas, in order to evaluate and improve their own work.

The promotion of the 6 key skills – Communication; Application of number; Information Technology; Working with others; Improving own learning and performance; Problem solving.

Art requires a communication of ideas and cooperation between individuals to complete tasks. As children progress the need to use accurate skills and measurements is required. Pattern also plays a part in many designs.

Thinking skills

The skills of Information processing, reasoning, enquiry, creative thinking, and evaluation are developed through our teaching and learning.

The problem solving elements of design and working to a brief are ideal to promote the development of thinking skills. Evaluation and reflection is a pivotal element of Art. These skills are further developed within clubs.

Monitoring and evaluation of teaching and learning

Procedures for monitoring teaching and learning are set out in subject management, assessment and other support policies.

Planning and work samples are used for evidence in monitoring teaching and learning. The skills required for Art are reviewed throughout the year. The development of skills are regularly reviewed to ensure progression throughout the school. Subject leaders identify strengths and areas of development. Within Year groups children are using sketchbooks to show a range of skills and progression linked to Artists.

Staff and school development

There are planned professional development sessions for staff to investigate different media and tools when required, and to review the progression of skills as the children develop. Teachers who have a creative background support other staff with the teaching of certain art skills and ideas.

Review

This policy will be reviewed as part of the subject development programme. It will be re-drafted as necessary taking account of the school's development plan and new local and national curriculum requirements.